CharjCo's Business Pitch to #NoExperienceNecesssary & Ronnen Harary

Power Up. Take Action. Take Charj.

By Toby You and Sophia Peng, Co-founders of CharjCo LLC

Our Problem

As college students and members of Gen Z, we noticed the growing necessity of being powered up. Our livelihoods are becoming accessed on our phones: our university course work, dearest AI assistants, communication with our families oceans away, payment for the subway and dinner–even our car keys. Within the fast pace of our lives, our worst nightmare becomes a dead phone when we're out. This anxiety is not unique to us: nine in ten people report panicking when their battery drops below 20%, a feeling now called "low battery anxiety."[1] According to a 2025 Talker Research survey of 2,000 Americans, the average person starts to worry once their phone hits 38%, and Gen Z gets anxious even sooner, at about 44%.[2] And what needs to be charged is not only our phones: our smartwatches, AI eyeglasses, headphones–all of these devices we carry mobile throughout our day need to stay powered up. Keeping a charged portable on us at all times is heavy, tedious, and unaesthetic, and it's one more thing to remember to charge. Charj is our solution: scan to rent a power bank at a Charj kiosk and take it with you to keep your devices powered up wherever you are to capture memories, an important interview, your late-night-Uber back home–at the moments where you need it most. Return anywhere, so you can charge stress-free as you travel and take the day.

Business Model

Charj is set to build a portable charger rental network: encounter a station, scan a QR code, take a portable power bank, and return it at any convenient Charj location. Our kiosks will be placed in primarily private establishments where people come-and-go: cafes, restaurants, bookstores, etc. These will be done through partnerships with local businesses that will receive a commission per rental from their kiosk location. Not only will partnered establishments receive free installation and monetary commission, they will also gain foot traffic from Charj users who walk in looking to scan for a power bank. Our revenue will primarily come from a per hour rental fee. A

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[1] LG Electronics Canada, "Canadians First in the World to Get Relief When LG X Power Launches in July," press release, Newswire, July 5, 2016, https://newswire.ca/news-releases/new-lg-x-power-smartphone-could-be-the-cure-for-canadians-low-battery-stress-585526941.html. The release reports results from the LG Electronics Smartphone "Low Battery Anxiety" Survey, conducted online by Ebiquity among 2,000 U.S. adult smartphone users, February 26–March 2, 2016.

[2] Rick Maughan, "Poll: Phone at 38%? That's When Most Americans Start to Panic," Talker Research, April 8, 2025, https://talkerresearch.com/poll-phone-at-38-thats-when-most-americans-start-to-panic/.

temporary hold will be put on a customer's card after successful rental to promote timely return of power banks; if a customer does not return within a certain timeframe (24 hours, for example) the deposit will be charged. This rental based power bank business model is tried and true in other parts of the world such as East and Southeast Asia, but is under-developed in North America. Charj hopes to adopt and deliver this model along with our own creative innovations.

Why do we care?

"One of the most important elements of running a successful business is momentum… The key is to keep moving, keep products flowing, and not stagnate"
–Ronnen Harary, *No Experience Necessary*

We care about taking action. Momentum is essential to our daily lives. For us, it's always about catching the next opportunity, documenting our present successes, and sharing it with our families across the world. And, what kills our momentum oftentimes is something so minute: a dead phone. With Charj, we are not simply charging people's devices; we are enabling them to work their flow uninterrupted–to *keep moving*.

Why Now?

"Surfing the zeitgeist doesn't always mean chasing the obviously trendy thing, like the internet in the late nineties or AI today. You can use technological and cultural shifts to re-invent and redefine any established industry."
–Ronnen Harary, *No Experience Necessary*

As we depend more and more on our mobile devices in our day-to-day life, we also need a mobile way to keep us charged up. Surfing the zeitgeist for us does not mean becoming an AI company; rather, it means powering everything AI and our devices now ask of us. Our phones have become our wallets, keys, tickets, maps, and cameras, and features like on-device AI drain them faster than ever. Mobile power demand will only continue to climb, and Charj seeks to meet that very demand. Furthermore, for the newer generations, what we carry is part of who we are: phone cases and charms have become part of fashion culture; power banks haven't–yet. Charj seeks to invent our power banks into pop culture.

Our Next Steps (What are we doing with $25,000?)

"Following your dreams may feel like a big gamble, but you're taking an even bigger gamble when you fail to believe in yourself. The greatest risk is a life unlived. Go live yours now."
–Ronnen Harary, *No Experience Necessary*

1. Fund our first production run (~$9,900+)

The response, affirmations, support, and push of momentum from these last seven days gave us the confidence to take our biggest step yet. We borrowed from friends and family and took the gamble of putting our products into production: 50 kiosks and 400 chargers. We kept the order intentionally small: large enough to launch a real network, but small enough to limit our risk while demand is still being tested. Another reason we decided to confirm production is to help land more partnerships: it is much easier to earn a firm handshake when you can put a working kiosk in front of these business owners. The potential profits from partnership can be made available immediately. After these considerations, we set sail on the ship to our dreams, fueled by a steadfast faith in ourselves and our idea. Upon reception of our grant, we will principally reimburse our production and shipping fees. Any funds that we have left after maintenance will be put toward a second production run after demand is thoroughly tested after launch.



2. Build density

A rental network only works when a station is always nearby. A secondary portion of our grant would be set aside for the expansion of installations concentrated in big cities such as New York City, where people often walk or take public transit, on-the-go and away from an accessible charging source. Going door to door pre-product, we asked 52 businesses in Morningside Heights, NYC and earned 5 tentative yeses, with about 10 more pledged locations in Boston. Many other business owners and managers were only open to the idea when immediate compensation (one-time payment) was offered in addition to free installation on us. The initial recruitment of partnerships will be difficult, with each marginal partnership costing less as we build our brand credibility and popularity. With a portion of this grant, our goal is to make a Charj kiosk “as accessible as the next subway station.”

3. Launch Charj artist-edition power banks (~$1,500)

With the final portion of our grant, we will commission local art students to design one-of-a-kind artist-edition power banks, turning a utility into a trendy fashion accessory. The artist-edition power banks will be less supplied than our standard design and will in turn create excitement, customer loyalty, and natural marketing as users scan in hopes that an artist-edition power bank

will pop out. We also seek to create a platform for freelance artists and students to be commissioned for their creativity. We hope to commission six more designs and produce 100 more power banks in our next stage after launch.



Design names from left to right: "pig and puppy", "the cloud collector", "inner bloom", "boy and the green cloud"
Artist names from left to right: Qianxun Lou, Shuyi Zhuang, Yifei Hu, Qianxun Lou

Conclusion

"Luck is not the same as chance. Chance is random. It's a fluke. Luck is what happens when you create an opportunity for yourself, have the ability to see it, and have the confidence to actualize it."
–Ronnen Harary, *No Experience Necessary*

Seven months ago, we didn't know how to write code, build hardware, or talk to a factory. Today, we have a registered company, a working product, a first production run, and a growing community of users and partners. We exemplify that no experience is necessary–only a burning passion, a great idea, and faith in ourselves.

With $25,000, we'll put our first kiosks into the city, launching a network dense enough that a charge is always within reach, and turn the humble power bank into the next fashion statement. We run on one mission: no one should ever lose their momentum to a dead battery.

We'll keep you powered up. You keep taking action. And whenever you need it, take Charj.